

Nepal National ID (NID) — Basics & FAQ

Department of National ID and Civil Registration (DONIDCR) | Ministry of Home Affairs

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1. What is the National Identity Card (NID)?

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_001 | topic:what_is_nid | source:nid_basics]

The National Identity Card (NID), known in Nepali as *Rastriya Parichayapatra*, is a multi-purpose smart card based on biometric technology. It contains both demographic data (personal information) and biometric data (fingerprints, iris scan, photo, digital signature) of the cardholder. It is issued by the Department of National ID and Civil Registration (DONIDCR) under the Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of Nepal.

The NID is Nepal's primary digital identity solution — a government-issued biometric smart card embedded with an electronic chip. It serves as official proof of identity for all Nepali citizens aged 16 and above who hold a valid citizenship certificate.

2. Why is the NID necessary?

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_002 | topic:why_nid_required | source:nid_basics]

Once the NID is made mandatory, it must be presented to access any government service or benefit. The NID serves as the primary basis for obtaining public services and as proof of personal identity.

Services requiring NID include:

- Obtaining a passport (NID number is mandatory for e-passport applications)
- Receiving social security allowances
- Receiving government relief and grants
- Voting in elections
- Buying or selling property
- Civil registration (birth, death, marriage registration)
- Opening a bank account and conducting financial transactions
- Purchasing a mobile SIM card
- PAN registration, driving licence, land registration, company registration

3. Who is eligible for a NID?

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_003 | topic:eligibility | source:nid_basics]

Any person who has obtained a Nepali citizenship certificate and is 16 years of age or older is eligible to apply for a National Identity Card.

Phase 1 (current): NID is issued only to citizens who hold a citizenship certificate.

Phase 2 (upcoming): Minors (under 16), Non-Resident Nepalis (NRN), and foreign nationals residing in Nepal will also become eligible. The public will be notified before Phase 2 begins.

4. Required Documents for NID Registration

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_004 | topic:required_documents | source:nid_basics]

The following original documents are required:

Document	When Required
Original Nepali Citizenship Certificate	Mandatory for all applicants
Migration Certificate (Basai Sarai Praman Patra)	Required if your current permanent address differs from the address on your citizenship certificate
Marriage registration certificate / Relationship certificate	Required if married and spouse's name is on your citizenship certificate
Proof of date of birth	Required only if date of birth is NOT shown on citizenship certificate
Any other supporting documents	As requested by the enrollment officer

Important: Documents that are unclear, torn, self-corrected, photocopied, or damaged will NOT be accepted. Only original, legible documents are accepted for NID registration.

5. How to Apply for a NID — Step by Step

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_005 | topic:application_process | source:nid_basics]

Step 1 — Fill the Application Form (two methods available):

Method A — Online form (recommended): Visit enrollment.donidcr.gov.np. Enter your personal/demographic details. After completing the form, the system generates an Application ID and QR Code. Print the receipt with the Application ID/QR Code and bring it to the nearest NID enrollment station for biometric capture.

Method B — Manual paper form: Collect the paper form from the District Administration Office (DAO) or Area Administration Office (AAO). Fill in your personal details. If you cannot fill the form yourself, a staff member can assist — but you must sign the declaration that all information is correct.

Step 2 — Verification Officer (Ruju Adhikari) Review:

The verification officer checks: application form details are correct; citizenship certificate is original, clear, and undamaged; date of birth is stated clearly in both B.S. and A.D.; spouse's name is present if required; address discrepancies are supported by a migration certificate. If everything is in order, the officer endorses the form and sends it to the data entry operator.

Step 3 — Data Entry Operator Captures Details:

The operator enters demographic details into the system and proceeds to biometric capture: 10-finger fingerprints, iris scan of both eyes, live photograph, and digital signature. A Confirmation Page is printed — review all details carefully. If any error is found, it is corrected before you sign. Once you sign the Confirmation Page, it is returned to the verification officer for final authentication.

Step 4 — Receive Your NID Number:

At DAO/AAO stations: NID number (NIN) is issued immediately.

At ward-level campaign stations: NIN is sent via SMS within a few days.

Step 5 — Collect the Physical NID Card:

You will receive an SMS when your card is printed and ready. Collect the card from the same location where you registered. You MUST be present in person — biometric verification is required at collection.

6. What Information is Stored on the NID Card?

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_006 | topic:card_contents | source:nid_basics]

Demographic / Personal Data:

- Full name (first, middle, last)

- Date of birth
- Gender
- Parents' names (father and mother)
- Permanent and temporary address
- Citizenship certificate number and type
- Spouse's name (if applicable)
- Grandfather and grandmother names
- Nationality
- NID number (10-digit unique National Identity Number)

Biometric Data:

- Fingerprints of all 10 fingers
 - Iris scan of both eyes
 - Photograph
 - Digital signature
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7. What is the NID Number (NIN)?

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_007 | topic:nin_number | source:nid_basics]

The National Identity Number (NIN) is a unique 10-digit number assigned to each individual by the Department of National ID and Civil Registration. This number is non-repeating — no two citizens share the same NIN. It serves as the citizen's primary identification number across all government and private sector systems.

How to check your NIN after registration: Send an SMS: type N [space] [your application number] and send to 30001. Or call the NID call center at 01-5970449.

8. Data Security and Privacy

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_008 | topic:data_security | source:nid_basics]

All collected data is stored in the Government Integrated Data Center (GIDC) within a VPN inside the Ministry of Home Affairs premises. The data cannot be accessed from outside the ministry. All data is encrypted (AES-256 standard). Only authorized department staff can access the data. The system records who accessed the data, when, and for what purpose — enabling audit and surveillance if suspicious activity is detected.

Other government offices may access limited data only through authorized official tools — they can only see the specific information they are entitled to, not full records.

9. Special Circumstances for Biometric Capture

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_009 | topic:special_biometric | source:nid_basics]

If a person is missing some or all fingers, or is visually impaired (blind), their available biometric data is still collected with a note (Kaifiyat) recorded in the system.

For identical twins: each person's fingerprints and iris scans are unique, so there is no confusion even between identical twins.

10. Photo Requirements

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_010 | topic:photo_requirements | source:nid_basics]

A live photograph is taken at the enrollment station — you do not need to bring a passport photo.

NOT allowed during photo capture:

- Cosmetic makeup
- Hats or caps
- Burqa or face covering
- Heavy jewelry that covers facial features

Allowed: Sindur (vermilion), Tika, religious/cultural/ethnic identity markers such as headscarves, as long as the full face and both ears are clearly visible.

11. Date of Birth — When Not Listed on Citizenship

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_011 | topic:dob_not_on_citizenship | source:nid_basics]

If the date of birth is not clearly stated on the citizenship certificate, the NID enrollment officer will determine the date of birth using the following priority order:

1. Educational certificate (SLC/SEE or higher level)
2. Pension document
3. Passport issue date
4. Citizenship issue date (subtracting the stated age from the issue year)

Example: If citizenship states age 16 and was issued on 2026 Ashadh 18, then date of birth is recorded as 2010 Ashadh 18 — unless a school certificate or passport shows a later date, in which case that date takes precedence.

12. Address Discrepancy

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_012 | topic:address_discrepancy | source:nid_basics]

If your current permanent address differs from the address shown on your citizenship certificate, you can update it by providing:

- Migration Certificate (Basai Sarai Praman Patra), OR
- Residence proof document issued by a government authority

If the address changed due to local government restructuring (re-mapping of municipalities/wards), no certificate is required — the new address can be entered directly.

13. Husband's Surname on NID

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_013 | topic:surname_husband | source:nid_basics]

If your citizenship certificate does not include your husband's surname, you CANNOT add the husband's surname to the NID. To include the husband's surname on the NID, you must first get the citizenship certificate amended to include the husband's surname, then apply for the NID.

14. NID and the Citizenship Certificate

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_014 | topic:nid_vs_citizenship | source:nid_basics]

The NID does not replace the citizenship certificate. Both documents are constitutional provisions and both remain valid under current law. Each is used according to its applicable legal provisions.

15. Death of NID Holder

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_015 | topic:death_of_holder | source:nid_basics]

When an NID holder passes away, the NID is no longer valid/active. However, the deceased person's record is updated in the system and their data is securely retained in the database for archival and statistical purposes.

16. Penalties for False Information

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_016 | topic:penalties | source:nid_basics]

Submitting false information to obtain a NID is a criminal offense under the National Identity Card and Civil Registration Act, 2076:

- Imprisonment: 2 to 5 years
 - Fine: NPR 20,000 to NPR 50,000
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17. Contact Information

[CHUNK_TAG: nid_basics_017 | topic:contact_info | source:nid_basics]

Channel	Details
NID Number SMS inquiry	Send: N [space] [Application No.] to 30001
Viber / WhatsApp	9851316034 / 9851316035
Phone	01-4200014 or 9847346412
Call Center	01-5970449
Toll Free	16600196666
Website	https://donidcr.gov.np
Citizen Portal	https://citizenportal.donidcr.gov.np
NID Enrollment Portal	https://enrollment.donidcr.gov.np
Email — General	info@donidcr.gov.np
Email — NID	nid@donidcr.gov.np
Office Hours (Summer: mid-Jan to mid-Nov)	Sunday–Friday, 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM
Office Hours (Winter: mid-Nov to mid-Jan)	Sunday–Friday, 9:00 AM – 4:00 PM